

# **Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings – Census 2021 ‘ASHE-Census 2021’ (formerly the ‘Earnings and Employees Study’) Guidance Document**

## **DRAFT Version**

The ASHE-Census 2021 dataset is scheduled for release in Spring/Summer 2026. Upon release, a final version of this document will be provided, including further detail on linkage rates, statistical disclosure control and any restricted variables.

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## Version control

| Version | Date       | Changes Made                                                                                                                                                                | Dataset Version | Owner                        | Contact          |
|---------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------|------------------|
| 1.0     | March 2026 | Draft version issued for information to support the ADR UK PhD funding opportunity. The final version will be published alongside the dataset release (Spring/Summer 2026). | 2014–2022       | NISRA ELMS and Census Office | rsu@nisra.gov.uk |
|         |            |                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |                              |                  |
|         |            |                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |                              |                  |
|         |            |                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |                              |                  |

# 1. Introduction

This document provides guidance to researchers on the ASHE-Census (formerly the ‘Earnings and Employees Study’ (EES)) 2021 database. The ASHE-Census 2021 database is a de-identified themed dataset including longitudinal data (2014-2022) from the Northern Ireland (NI) [Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings \(ASHE\)](#) linked to the [NI Census of Population](#) 2021 (hereafter referred to as ‘Census’).

The ASHE is a UK wide survey that provides data on hourly, weekly and annual earnings by gender, work patterns, industry and occupation, including public versus private sector pay comparisons. The Census collects information every 10 years about people and households in Northern Ireland. It is used by central and local government, health authorities and many other organisations to plan and provide future services.

The database has been created through the Administrative Data Research (ADR) NI using the Digital Economy Act 2017 as the legal gateway. The directive of the ADR NI has been to provide a secure and accredited research environment to enable agreed, ethically approved and cross-cutting research to be conducted using administrative data sets that are routinely collected and analysed by NICS departments and other bodies. The ultimate aims of the joined-up approach are to inform the development and monitoring of public policy and to help ensure that decision making is evidence-based and the research provides a benefit to society. The ADR NI makes it possible for trained researchers to use **pseudonymised** administrative data for social and economic research, while making sure the data remain safe and the **privacy of individuals and businesses are protected**.

The NISRA Research Support Unit (RSU) plays a central operational role within ADR NI by supporting accredited researchers to access de-identified administrative datasets in a safe, secure and legally compliant way. The RSU manages researcher accreditation, oversees project approvals, and provides day-to-day coordination of data access. In doing so, the RSU ensures that all use of ADR NI data adheres to the Digital Economy Act 2017, NISRA’s confidentiality obligations, and strict information governance standards, while enabling high-quality, impactful research that benefits society.

Researchers should note that NISRA has strict disclosure rules in place when analysing our data as we are bound by the Code of Practice for Statistics, and the legislation under which we collect the data i.e. The Statistics of Trade and Employment (NI) Order 1988 for the ASHE, and The Census Act (Northern Ireland) 1969 for Census, to protect the identity of businesses and individuals who provide their information to us. Therefore, we must ensure that the identity of businesses and individuals that provide information to us is protected at all times. This means that it is not possible to make certain variables available to researchers such as business address or postcode. It also dictates the disclosure rules that determine what can and cannot be published from analysis of our data.

The Code of Practice for Statistics also places a duty on NISRA to minimise business burden when responding to statutory surveys. This requirement has implications for matters such as the sample size of a survey and the length of a survey.

Included in this document are background information on the data sources that constitute the ASHE-Census 2021 database, a description of the database and how researchers can access the data.

Also included is a description of variables and caveats that are essential for the understanding of the database structure. When applying to use the ASHE-Census 2021 data this document should be used in conjunction with the accompanying metadata and data dictionary.

It should be noted that a 2011 version of the ASHE-Census database is also available. Known at the time as the '[Earnings and Employees Study \(EES\) 2011](#)', this dataset links together data from the ASHE 2011 with the 2011 Census and was released for accredited research purposes in November 2021. A separate [guidance document](#) is available for this dataset.

A number of research projects have been completed using the ASHE-Census 2011 dataset and feedback from researchers has been incorporated into the development of the 2021 version. For example, researchers expressed a need for longitudinal ASHE data which has been included in the 2021 release.

The owners of this document are NISRA ELMS and Census Office. Any changes to this document should be suggested to NISRA Research Support Unit (RSU) in the first instance (rsu@nisra.gov.uk).

## 1.1 Data Collection, Validation, Imputation Processes & Revisions

### 1.1.1 Data collection

The ASHE is administered by the Economic and Labour Market Statistics (ELMS) Branch within NISRA. To administer and collect the data, ELMS utilise an advanced data collection system which facilitates data collection via online and paper formats.

The NI Census is administered by the Census Office within NISRA. To conduct the Census, NISRA employs a comprehensive, large-scale data collection operation that combines secure online completion, paper questionnaires, and targeted field follow-up for non-responding households. The collection process is supported by purpose-built census management systems which track returns, coordinate fieldwork, and ensure complete and accurate enumeration of all households and individuals across Northern Ireland.

#### 1.1.1.1 ASHE Sampling Frame – Inter Departmental Business Register

The Inter Departmental Business Register (IDBR) is the sampling frame used to obtain contact details of employers of individuals sampled within the ASHE, while the HM Revenue and Customs' (HMRC's) Pay As You Earn (PAYE) system is used to draw the ASHE sample.

The IDBR consists of companies, partnerships, sole proprietors, public authorities, central government departments, local authorities and non-profit making bodies in the UK.

The IDBR covers most of the economy including the Agriculture, Production, Construction and Service sectors in Northern Ireland. It does not, however, include very small businesses which are not VAT registered (the threshold for VAT in 2024/25 was £90,000) unless they operate a PAYE scheme. This means that many self-employed workers will not be included on the IDBR.

In 2025, the IDBR estimates that the number of VAT and/or PAYE registered businesses operating in Northern Ireland was 81,135.

However, the [Department for Business and Trade \(DBT\)](#) estimates (Table 23) that in 2025 there were approximately 62,290 unregistered businesses in Northern Ireland, which is in addition to the figures reported by the IDBR.

*(Please note the definitional difference: DBT and ONS use count of enterprises from the IDBR whereas NISRA use count of businesses operating in NI.)*

The business activity, or industry, is recorded using Standard Industrial Classification (UK SIC 2007) codes.

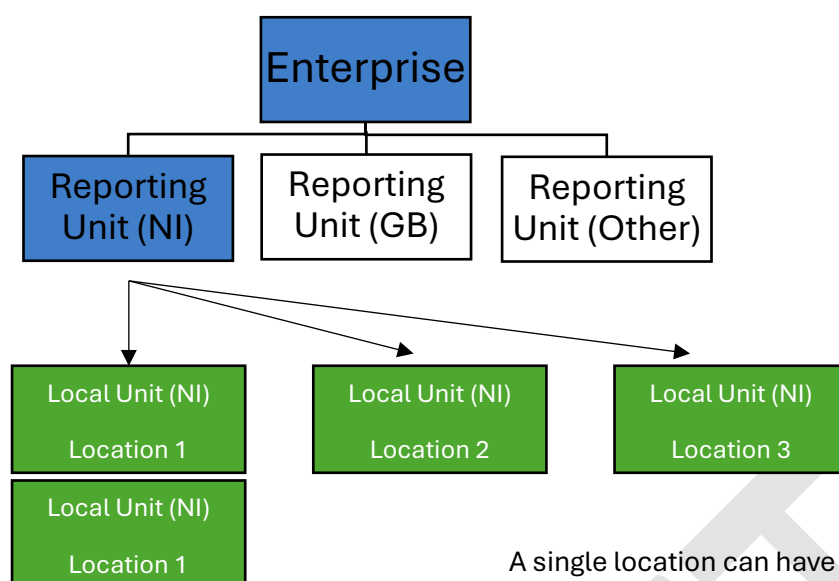
Statistical units are classified using a hierarchy which is described below.

- **Enterprise Group:** a group of legal units under common ownership. Enterprise is the smallest combination of legal units (generally based on VAT and/or PAYE records) which has a certain degree of autonomy within an Enterprise Group. The geographical location of an Enterprise is based on its registered (or main) UK address. Note that the database does not include any variables relating to Enterprises.
- **Reporting Unit:** includes all or part of an Enterprise. There will be at least one Northern Ireland Reporting Unit for any business operating in Northern Ireland.
- **Local Unit:** an individual site (for example a factory or shop). Usually, all sites in Northern Ireland are included in a single Reporting Unit. A Northern Ireland Reporting Unit will not include any sites outside Northern Ireland.

The ONS defines a business as an enterprise and assigns each business to a geographical location based on its registered or main address, within the UK. This is the standard EU definition but has the disadvantage that the Northern Ireland figures will not include any businesses operating in Northern Ireland, which have their main or registered address elsewhere in the UK. An alternative approach is to define each Northern Ireland Reporting Unit as a business. This ensures that all businesses operating in Northern Ireland are included but has the drawback that any Enterprise with more than one Reporting Unit in Northern Ireland will be counted as multiple businesses.

To address these issues an Enterprise operating within Northern Ireland definition has been introduced. Under this definition each Enterprise operating in Northern Ireland is included in the Northern Ireland figures but only once and the industrial classification, employment/employees and turnover information only relate to the part of the business located in Northern Ireland. Where the Enterprise has more than one Northern Ireland Reporting Unit the data for the individual Reporting Units are aggregated to form a composite unit. The industrial classification for the composite unit is determined based on the industrial classifications of the local units contained within the unit, using the same method as is used for a standard Reporting Unit. Where a business operates across multiple SICs at different local units, the dominant SIC across LUs as determined by employment is applied to the RU. This also applies when combining RUs to create a composite unit. The location of the composite unit is determined based on the address of the site with overall responsibility for Northern Ireland activity or the primary operating site within Northern Ireland.

The relationship between enterprises, reporting unit and local unit is depicted below.



### 1.1.1.2 ASHE Sampling Frame – HM Revenue and Customs Pay As You Earn system

The ASHE survey uses a random sample of 1% of all employee jobs from HM Revenue and Customs's (HMRC's) Pay As You Earn (PAYE) system, taken in January of the reference year. The sample is drawn in such a way that many of the same individuals are included from year to year, thereby allowing longitudinal analysis of the data.

The sample is matched against the IDBR in order to obtain contact and address details for the employers. Information on the hours paid and earnings of employees is obtained from employers and treated confidentially.

The survey has a reference date in April and asks about individuals who were employees at that time. The reference date changes each year depending on when Easter falls. A second extract is taken from the PAYE system in April in order to identify people who have either joined the labour market or changed jobs since the January sample was taken.

Since ASHE is a survey of employee jobs, it does not cover the self-employed or any jobs within the armed forces. Given the survey reference date in April, the survey does not fully cover certain types of seasonal work, for example, employees taken on for only summer or winter work.

Statistical units included within the ASHE are described below.

- **Jobs:** individuals within the ASHE can have multiple jobs. The number of jobs can be ascertained by a count of rows per year.
- **Individuals:** the number of individuals can be ascertained by a count of the variable Anonymised\_piden per year.
- **Reporting Unit:** includes all or part of an Enterprise. There will be at least one Northern Ireland Reporting Unit for any business operating in Northern Ireland. The number of reporting units can be ascertained by a count of the variable Anonymised\_RURef per year.

### 1.1.1.3 Census Address Register

The NI Census is undertaken by NISRA's Census Office. It usually takes place once every ten years and is the largest and most complex statistical exercise undertaken here. Census statistics are a vital source of information and are widely used by government, public bodies, academia, commercial businesses and others to develop policies, allocate resources and help deliver services.

The NI Census 2021 collected information on the usually resident population of Northern Ireland on 21 March 2021 and was based on a comprehensive enumeration frame constructed from the Census Address Register (CAR). The CAR was developed primarily from the Land & Property Services POINTER database, supplemented with additional administrative and utility data, to provide the most complete list of residential addresses and communal establishments for contacting households and guiding follow-up activity.

Although the Census aimed to capture every usual resident, it achieved a 97% household response rate, the highest of the last three censuses. As with any full-enumeration exercise, limitations remained, including non-response, under- and over coverage, and difficulties in enumerating certain hard-to-reach groups, which were addressed through follow-up field operations and statistical adjustment methods documented in its coverage and quality assurance materials (see [Section 2.2](#) and [Annex C](#) for further information).

### 1.1.2 Data validation

When data is received, it undergoes a series of quality assurance checks to identify missing information, inconsistencies, structural issues, unusual values, and issues with aggregations. Any anomalies are reviewed by staff, who investigate their cause and, where appropriate, seek clarification from the relevant data provider. These steps help ensure that the data used for analysis and results production is robust, reliable, and fit for purpose. Further information is presented in [Section 1.2](#).

### 1.1.3 Imputation

For ASHE, donor imputation is carried out for missing data items on partial returns; no non-responder imputation is carried out.

For Census 2021, missing or inconsistent responses are addressed through established edit and imputation procedures to produce a complete and internally consistent dataset.

There are no imputation markers available on the datasets.

### 1.1.4 Revisions

Across official statistics, published figures may occasionally be updated when new information becomes available or when methodological or processing improvements are identified. For survey-based outputs such as ASHE, results are often released initially as provisional and later updated to revised figures once additional data and validation have been incorporated, as shown in NISRA's publication of ASHE 2025 (provisional) and ASHE 2024 (revised).

For Census 2021, results were published only after the completion of extensive processing, edit, imputation and quality assurance procedures, and NISRA does not present Census outputs as

provisional. While corrections may be applied if necessary, Census results are generally treated as final following release.

Revisions, where they occur, help ensure that published statistics remain accurate and high-quality while supporting the timely release of data.

All data within the ASHE-Census 2021 dataset are finalised. See Annex C for revisions policies.

## 1.2 Quality Assurance

Quality assurance practices were applied by ELMS (to the ASHE dataset) and Census Office (to the Census 2021 data) to ensure the data were accurate, reliable, and representative. In addition, RSU undertook further quality assurance and data-cleaning procedures to identify and resolve inconsistencies within the linked dataset, ensuring the final data supplied for research use were as reliable and accurate as possible. RSU also completed a statistical disclosure control assessment of the data.

### 1.2.1 Consistency within the data

The datasets were checked for anomalies, unexpected values and issues with aggregations. Any resulting queries were relayed to the data providers for further information and advice to resolve the issues. Data owners are continually seeking ways to reduce the instances of inconsistencies within the data, however it should be noted that some minor inconsistencies occur within the ASHE dataset in relation to sex. Changes to the recording of sex across or within years are likely due to collection errors and researchers are advised to treat these as such.

### 1.2.2 Consistency with published reports

As ASHE forms the spine of the linked dataset, RSU sought to replicate key ASHE headline statistics to ensure that the ASHE component of the ASHE-Census 2021 database accurately reflects the data used in published ASHE outputs. Where discrepancies were identified, these were investigated and remedial action taken to ensure consistency between the ASHE component of the database and published ASHE statistics.

Census variables in the ASHE-Census database relate only to individuals who appear in the ASHE sample and have been successfully linked. These Census data therefore do not represent the full Census population and cannot be compared directly with published Census headline figures. Instead, RSU calculated bespoke frequencies for Census Person variables using a demographic profile aligned with ASHE (economically active-excluding self-employed and unemployed-and aged 16–74 years). For Household variables, RSU used NLS Census 2021 data, sampling the households of NLS members who met the same criteria. Where there were discrepancies between distributions, this was due to bespoke aggregation of variables by Census or the unavailability of a published figures for a similar sample for comparison.

### 1.2.3 Statistical Disclosure Control (SDC)

RSU worked with data providers to ensure that the data provided was safe and that it could not be used to disclose small numbers. For instance, feedback from researchers included the desire to incorporate geographical markers such as post codes or Super Output Area/Super Data Zone markers.

RSU and ELMS undertook disclosure testing to determine whether or not this would be viable. Given the small size of the NI economy and business population, it was determined that providing SOA markers would likely cause disclosure issues.

ELMS have strict disclosure rules in place as we are bound by the Code of Practice for Statistics, and the legislation, to protect the identity of businesses who provide their information to us. These same rules are applied to all of our business statistics and associated outputs. As such these geographical variables cannot be made available.

However, we have agreed to include Local Government District markers on the datasets as this is considered to be the safest geographical identifier available.

The RSU SDC team carried out further analysis on the linked ASHE-Census dataset, making recommendations to place additional restrictions on the data where the risk of disclosure was deemed high. RSU provided an SDC report and discussed the recommendations with data providers, making any necessary amendments to the data based on the advice received.

## 2 ASHE-Census Datasets

The ASHE-Census 2021 dataset is comprised of two large scale datasets which are highlighted below and with further information available in subsequent sections.

1. Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings (ASHE), 2014-2022.
2. Census of Population ('Census') 2021.

### 2.1 NI ASHE

The ASHE for Northern Ireland is conducted on a statutory basis under the Statistics of Trade and Employment (Northern Ireland) Order 1988 (Article 5). It collects data on earnings by gender, work patterns, industry, occupation, and public vs. private sector pay comparisons. The ASHE is a National Statistic<sup>1</sup> dataset comprising approximately 1% of all employees in NI who were covered by Pay As You Earn (PAYE) schemes.

The ASHE-Census 2021 dataset contains annual ASHE data from 2014-2022. Salient points to note around the dataset include:

- **Sampling Frame**

ASHE sample size and returns from 2014 to 2022 are as follows:

| Year                                        | 2014            | 2015            | 2016            | 2017            | 2018            | 2019            | 2020            | 2021            | 2022            |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| ASHE                                        |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |
| <b>Record numbers (sample size/returns)</b> | 3,091/<br>2,311 | 3,147/<br>2,293 | 3,114/<br>2,375 | 3,118/<br>2,378 | 3,196/<br>2,266 | 3,249/<br>2,397 | 3,191/<br>2,195 | 3,155/<br>2,248 | 3,310/<br>2,378 |

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<sup>1</sup> National Statistics status means that our statistics meet the highest standards of trustworthiness, quality, and public value, and it is our responsibility to maintain compliance with these standards. National Statistics accreditation is granted by the UK statistics Authority following comprehensive and independent assessment of the statistics.

- **Sample size**

The ASHE sample includes approximately 8,000 jobs across 3,000 businesses per year.

- **Classifications**

The UK Standard Industrial Classification of Economic Activities 2007 (SIC 2007) is the classification framework used to define the industry in which a business operates. This is used by all business surveys within the UK.

- **Inclusions and exclusions**

The ASHE dataset contains information on jobs in all industries and occupations. It does not cover the self-employed. Given the survey reference date in April, the survey does not fully cover certain types of seasonal work, for example, employees taken on for only summer or winter work.

- **Weights**

Returned data are weighted to NI population totals from the Labour Force Survey (LFS) based on classes defined by occupation, region, age and sex. There are two processes involved in the weighting of responses for ASHE.

The first allocates individual cases a design weight to adjust for non-response. For this purpose, responses are treated as being in one of four strata, depending on whether they were part of the original questionnaire despatch, one of the later supplementary surveys or have a special arrangement in place with ONS to return their data electronically.

For the second part of the weighting, the final file of responses is post-stratified to population estimates taken from the LFS in 108 post-strata. These post-strata are defined as a cross-classification of:

- occupation (nine groups) – major groups from [Standard Occupational Classification 2010](#)
- age-band (three groups) – 16 to 21 years, 22 to 49 years and 50 years and over
- sex (two groups) – male and female
- region (two groups) – London and South East, and the rest of the UK

In order to produce estimates for the number of jobs falling below the National Minimum Wage, the dataset is re-weighted to exclude employees whose earnings were affected by absence during the reference pay period.

Users should note that weight variables are used in the production of the ASHE published tables. In order to replicate published ASHE estimates, the weighting variable 'calwght' should be used. The only exception to this is when estimating numbers of jobs with pay below the NLW/NMW or living wage, for which 'lpcalwghtf' should be used for 2021 and 'lpcalwght' for 2022.

It is also important to include the correct filters. Below is an example of the use of weights and filters to calculate summary figures for weekly pay-gross using STATA code:

```
summarize gpay [aweight = calwght] if (adr==1 & lop==2 & age>15), detail
```

- **Job vs Individual vs Reporting Unit vs Local Unit**

The **ASHE dataset provides information at job and individual employee levels**. While the ASHE dataset includes the Anonymised\_RURef variable, the ASHE dataset does not include information at Reporting Unit level but rather SIC and geographical data relate to the individual business (Local Unit) which employs the individual employee sampled within the data.

## 2.2 NI Census of Population

The Census of Population ('Census') 2021 provides a comprehensive count of all usual residents and households in Northern Ireland. It was conducted by NISRA's Census Office on 21 March 2021. The Census is a statutory exercise carried out under the Census Act (Northern Ireland) 1969, ensuring compulsory participation and enabling high-quality population statistics.

The ASHE-Census dataset incorporates person- and household-level information from Census 2021. Key points to note include:

- **Coverage**

Census 2021 is a full enumeration - it aims to include every household and resident in Northern Ireland. The exercise uses the Central Address Register (CAR) to support the identification and classification of all residential addresses and to assist with field operations during collection.

- **Response and Data Quality**

NISRA provides detailed methodology and quality documentation for Census 2021. This includes:

- Census 2021 [statement about data quality](#), covering overall response rate and item-level response rates.
- [Census Quality Survey \(CQS\) results](#), which measure agreement between Census responses and re-interview survey data.
- [Quality assurance reports](#) assessing accuracy and completeness of population estimates.

Imputation and editing were used to address missing or inconsistent data, following detailed statistical rules documented in the Census 2021 [Edit and Imputation Processing Report](#).

- **Classifications**

Census 2021 uses established national classifications including:

- Standard Occupational Classification (SOC)
- Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) (for workplace- and commuting-related questions)
- Standard demographic classifications (age, sex, ethnicity, religion, identity, housing, travel, health etc.), reflected in published tables and metadata.

- **Inclusions and Exclusions**

The Census covers:

- All usual residents of Northern Ireland, including individuals in households and communal establishments.

It **does not** include:

- Visitors who are not usual residents.
- Individuals living outside NI on Census Day.

#### • **Weights**

Census 2021 does not use survey weights in the way ASHE does. Instead, coverage assessment and adjustment processes are conducted to ensure full population coverage, supported by:

- Edit and imputation procedures.
- Quality assurance processes that compare Census estimates with administrative sources and demographic benchmarks.

#### • **Job vs Individual vs Household Unit**

Within the ASHE-Census dataset, the Census component provides information at both individual and household levels:

- Individual variables (age, sex, qualifications, health, etc.).
- Household characteristics (household composition, accommodation type, tenure, rooms, central heating, etc.).

## 3 Linkage

### 3.1 Linkage methodology

A Trusted Third Party (TTP) carries out the linkage for ADR NI datasets. The role of TTP involves linking together datasets using limited personal information (e.g. name, date of birth and postcode) provided by data suppliers for the purpose of a specific ADR NI project. TTP use these links to provide the RSU team with an anonymous index of IDs which link between the datasets involved. The role of RSU is to bring together the attribute data using this index into a research dataset. TTP never have access to the attribute data.

TTP use a 'rules based' or deterministic linkage approach using Match-Keys. Match-Keys are created by putting together pieces of information to create unique keys that can be used for automated linking e.g.

Dataset 1

| ID | Forename | Surname | Sex | DOB        | Postcode | <b>Match-key 1:</b> Forename, Surname, Sex, DOB, Postcode |
|----|----------|---------|-----|------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | John     | Smith   | M   | 01/01/1990 | BT6 XXX  | JOHNSMITHM01011990BT6XXX                                  |

## Dataset 2

| ID | Forename | Surname | Sex | DOB        | Postcode | Match-key 1: Forename, Surname, Sex, DOB, Postcode |
|----|----------|---------|-----|------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | John     | Smith   | M   | 01/01/1990 | BT6 XXX  | JOHNSMITHM01011990BT6XXX                           |

TTP choose to accept a link between record 1 in dataset 1 and record 2 in dataset 2 because match key 1 is identical for both records. The variation in recording demographic information across datasets can occur in a number of different forms. A single match-key alone cannot resolve all of the differences that occur between data sources, hence the need for multiple Match-Keys. A series of Match-Keys have been developed, each of which is designed to resolve particular inconsistencies between match pairs. An example of a non-exact match-key is one constructed from the first two characters of an individual's forename and surname (Bi-grams), combined with their date of birth and postcode district. The strongest level of linking is exact linking, which links pairs of records that are identical on all linking fields. Typically, the Match-Keys are processed in a stepwise manner starting with the most exact match-key and working down to the last match-key.

## 3.2 Donor imputation

In order to produce a fully linked dataset, donor imputation is carried out to link the remaining unmatched ASHE individuals to Census individuals with similar characteristics. This follows the same deterministic linkage approach using Match-Keys as was used for the initial linkage. Match-Keys are created by putting together pieces of information to create unique keys that can be used for automated linking.

## 4 Research potential

It is hoped that research involving the ASHE-Census dataset will help to inform the development and monitoring of public policy as well as provide an evidence base for decision making. There are a number of potential ASHE-Census research themes. These include, but are not limited to: factors influencing variation in median pay; graduates and the workplace; disparity in pay and migration; public versus private jobs; and geography and pay. A list of potential research questions/topics can be found [here](#).

Research completed on the 2011 version of the dataset (known at the time as the 'Earnings and Employees Study (EES) 2011') includes:

[Estimating Catholic-Protestant wage differentials](#)

[The association between unpaid caring and employment and earnings in NI](#)

## 5 Data access

Access to the ASHE-Census NI dataset is limited to researchers and research teams with [accredited researcher status](#) under the Digital Economy Act 2017 (DEA) and subject to approval

by the data providers. In addition, all projects must be accredited by the UK Statistics Authority Research Accreditation Panel (RAP).

In the first instance, researchers should contact RSU via email at [rsu@nisra.gov.uk](mailto:rsu@nisra.gov.uk) to discuss their proposed project and should include details such as the main aims and objectives of the project as well as the methodological approach that they are intending to use and details of the data required. RSU, in consultation with the data providers, will use this information to determine the feasibility of the project, after which a [full application](#) can be completed and submitted by the researcher(s) to the RAP. Ethical approval will also be required for each project, details of which should be included in the application form. Ethics approval can also be sought through the research team's university ethics committee or via the [National Statistician's Ethics Advisory Committee](#). RSU will support the research team throughout the entire application process. Further information on how to apply for approval is available [here](#).

The ASHE-Census NI dataset may be accessed in the RSU secure research environment.

ASHE-Census NI may also be available with Access Level 2 within the ONS Secure Research Service (SRS) which permits access via Safe Rooms, SafePods, or through Assured Organisational Connectivity (AOC) office connection. Access via the ONS SRS will be considered on a project-by-project basis and subject to review by the RSU SDC team and approval by data providers which may require additional aggregations be applied to the data.

Upon approval by RAP and the data providers, researchers will be provided with the relevant variables in a flat file table. All research outputs will be checked by RSU or ONS using the NISRA RSU outputs clearance guidance and any final outputs released will be shared with the data providers.

**The ASHE-Census NI is a standalone dataset and cannot be linked to other datasets.**

## 6 Acknowledgements

When publishing or presenting findings from the ASHE-Census 2021 dataset the following acknowledgement should be used:

*Administrative Data Research - Northern Ireland (ADR-NI) takes privacy protection very seriously. All information that directly identifies individuals/organisations will be removed from the datasets by trusted third parties before researchers access them.*

*All researchers using ADR-NI are trained and accredited to use sensitive data safely and ethically, they will only access the data via a secure environment and all their findings will be vetted to ensure they comply with strict confidentiality requirements.*

*The help provided by the staff of the Administrative Data Research Centre - Northern Ireland (ADRC-NI) and the ADR-NI support officers within NISRA Research Support Unit (RSU) is acknowledged. ADR-NI is funded by the Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC). The authors alone are responsible for the interpretation of the data and any views or opinions presented are solely those of the author and do not necessarily represent those of ADR-NI. The NISRA ELMS data has been supplied for the sole purpose of this project.*

## Annex A: ASHE Variable Catalogue

| Variable Name | Variable Description                                                                                                                                                               | Further Information                                            |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Year          | Year for which the survey was conducted                                                                                                                                            | Years 2014-2022. The survey reference date is always in April. |
| Sex           | Sex                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                |
| Djob          | Double job marker - indicates people with more than one job                                                                                                                        |                                                                |
| Mjob          | Main job marker - indicates the main job, but only for people with more than one job                                                                                               |                                                                |
| Ft            | Full/part time marker - Full-time employees are defined as those who work more than 30 paid hours per week or those in teaching professions working 25 paid hours or more per week |                                                                |
| Empsta        | Employee start date                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                |
| Occ10         | Occupation of Employee                                                                                                                                                             | Years 2014 - 2020                                              |
| Occ20         | Occupation of Employee                                                                                                                                                             | Years 2021 - 2022                                              |
| Sjd           | Same job marker - Has the employee worked in the same job for more than one year                                                                                                   |                                                                |
| Pt            | Permanent/temporary marker                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                |
| Payp          | Pay period                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                |
| Bpay          | Basic Weekly Pay                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                |
| Ovpay         | Overtime pay - weekly overtime pay for the pay period                                                                                                                              |                                                                |
| Sppay         | Shift premium payments - Additional premium payments during the pay period for shift work and night or weekend work not treated as overtime                                        |                                                                |
| Ipall         | Incentive pay (2005) - Total incentive pay paid in this pay period, including any relating to another pay period                                                                   |                                                                |
| Ipain         | Incentive pay relating to this pay period (2005)                                                                                                                                   |                                                                |
| Othpay        | Other pay (2005)                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                |
| Tpay          | Total pay (2005)                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                |
| Gpay          | Gross pay - weekly earnings including overtime (bpay+ipain+sppay+ovpay+othpay)                                                                                                     |                                                                |
| Hexo          | Hourly earnings excluding overtime (gpox/bhr)                                                                                                                                      |                                                                |
| He            | Hourly earnings including overtime (gpay/thrs)                                                                                                                                     |                                                                |
| Gpox          | Gross weekly earnings excluding overtime                                                                                                                                           |                                                                |
| Hpay          | Stated hourly rate of pay                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                |
| Lop           | Earnings were affected by absence - Loss of pay marker                                                                                                                             |                                                                |
| Adr           | Adult rate marker                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                |

|                  |                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Anipay           | Annual incentive pay                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Agp              | Annual gross pay                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Bikfilter        | Benefits in kind filter                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Bik              | Benefits in kind(2005)                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Alday            | Annual leave - days                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Colag            | Collective agreement - national or industry agreement                                |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Bhr              | Basic paid hours/normal basic weekly hours                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Ovhrs            | Overtime Weekly hours                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Thrs             | Total Weekly hours (bhr+ovhrs)                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Sic07            | Standard Industrial Classification(2007)                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Age              | Age                                                                                  | The dataset only contains people aged 16 and over at the survey reference date                                                                                                         |
| Harea            | Home postcode LGD 2014                                                               | Note some individuals with more than one job in a single year have different Harea recorded for different jobs. This may be due to a change of address not updated with all employers. |
| Warea            | Work postcode LGD 2014                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Pubpriv          | Public private                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Bpayinc          | Basic Pay including Other Pay ( bpay+othpay)                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Dweight          | Survey Design weight                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Gweight          | Survey G weight                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Calwght          | Survey Calibration weight                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lpdweight        | Low pay Design weight                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lpgweight        | Low pay Population weight                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lpcalwght        | Low pay calibration weight                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Ppfilter         | Pension provision filter                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Tpen             | Type of Pension Scheme                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Penpay           | Pensionable Amount (2005) - The amount of employee's weekly pay that was pensionable |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Ownpay           | Employee Contribution to Pension (2005)                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Compay           | Employer contributions to Pension (2005) - weekly                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Ownperc          | Employee's percentage pension contribution                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Comperc          | Employer's percentage pension contribution                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| App              | Apprentice marker                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Appdate          | Apprenticeship state date                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Hrpayx           | The derived hourly rate used in low pay calculation                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Anonymised_Serno | Anonymised unique identifier for each year                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Anonymised_piden   | Anonymised Person Identifier                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Unique code identifies each employee within a business - so an RUPref can have more than 1 Person_Identifier        |
| LOPF               | Loss of pay but excluding furlough marker (only available for 2021)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Available 2020 and 2021.                                                                                            |
| Furlough           | Furlough Marker - Whether the employee has been furloughed on the COVID-19 Job Retention Scheme (CJRS)                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Available 2020 and 2021.                                                                                            |
| Lpdweightf         | Low pay Calibration D weight - only available for 2021, same as lpcalwghtf but based on stratum                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Only available for 2021                                                                                             |
| Lpgweightf         | Low pay calibration g weight - same as described for lpcalwghtf but based on LFS population totals stratum                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Only available for 2021                                                                                             |
| Lpcalwghtf         | Low pay calibration - the same as lpcalwght except that any cases with loss of pay due to absence who were furloughed are included (using Furlough). The aim is to produce weights similar to normal years' lpcalwght, i.e. excluding employees absent due to situations such as maternity/paternity leave, sickness etc. | Only available for 2021                                                                                             |
| Anonymised_RUPref  | Anonymised Reporting Unit Reference                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Anonymised version for linking                                                                                      |
| Idbrnemp           | IDBR employment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Please note that this information relates to the number of employees for a business at a UK rather than a NI level. |
| Stratum            | Relates to the way in which the data was collected from 2004                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                     |
| Lowhc              | Non minimum hours contract - was the employee on a contract that did not guarantee a minimum number of hours work?                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                     |
| MDM2017_W          | MDM 2017 Quintiles Work (introduced in ASHE 2018 onwards)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                     |
| MDM2017_P          | MDM 2017 Quintiles Home (introduced in ASHE 2018 onwards)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                     |
| Distance_to_work   | Distance travelled is calculated as the straight line distance, in kilometres, between place of residence and place of work.                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                     |
| Settlement15Band_H | Settlement Band 2015 (Home)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                     |
| Settlement15Band_W | Settlement Band 2015 (Work)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                     |
| GoodJob_flag       | This metric is one which meets the following requirements: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Year ≥ 2017</li> <li>• Lop = 2</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                             | - Data for 2017 are based on the real living wage rate of £8.45                                                     |

|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <math>Adr = 1</math></li> <li>• <math>Lowhc = 2</math></li> <li>• <math>Pt = 1</math></li> <li>• <math>16 \leq Age \leq 64</math></li> <li>• <math>HrpayX \geq \text{Real Living Wage}</math></li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Data for 2018 are based on the real living wage rate of £8.75</li> <li>- Data for 2019 are based on the real living wage rate of £9.00</li> <li>- Data for 2020 are based on the real living wage rate of £9.30</li> <li>- Data for 2021 are based on the real living wage rate of £9.50</li> <li>- Data for 2022 are based on the real living wage rate of £9.90</li> </ul> |
|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

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## Annex B: Census Variable Catalogue

### Person

| Variable Name                | Variable Description                                                                                                                                                             | Further Information |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| ENCRYPTED_PERSON_ID          | Encrypted ID for linking                                                                                                                                                         |                     |
| ENCRYPTED_HHID               | Encrypted Household ID for linking                                                                                                                                               |                     |
| MAR_CP_STATUS_P2             | Marital and Same Sex Civil Partnership Status                                                                                                                                    |                     |
| IN_FULL_TIME_EDUCATION_P2    | Schoolchild or full-time student indicator                                                                                                                                       |                     |
| COB_AGG20_P2                 | Census 2021 - Country of birth - aggregated (20 category)                                                                                                                        |                     |
| COB_AGG12_P2                 | Census 2021 - Country of birth - aggregated (12 category)                                                                                                                        |                     |
| COB_AGG9_P2                  | Census 2021 - Country of birth - aggregated (9 category)                                                                                                                         |                     |
| COB_AGG8_P2                  | Census 2021 - Country of birth - aggregated (8 category)                                                                                                                         |                     |
| COB_AGG5_P2                  | Census 2021 - Country of birth - aggregated (5 category)                                                                                                                         |                     |
| PASSPORTS_HELD_1000_AGG18_P2 | Census 2021 - Passport - aggregated (18 category)                                                                                                                                |                     |
| PASSPORTS_HELD_1000_AGG14_P2 | Census 2021 - Passport - aggregated (14 category)                                                                                                                                |                     |
| PASSPORTS_HELD_BASIC_P2      | Census 2021 – Passport (8 category)                                                                                                                                              |                     |
| PASSPORTS_HELD_1000_AGG4_P2  | Census 2021 - Passport - aggregated (4 category)                                                                                                                                 |                     |
| NAT_ID_NORTHERN_IRISH_P2     | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual self-identifies as Northern Irish, and/or any other national identities.                                                           |                     |
| NAT_ID_BRITISH_P2            | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual self-identifies as British, and/or any other national identities.                                                                  |                     |
| NAT_ID_IRISH_P2              | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual self-identifies as Irish, and/or any other national identities.                                                                    |                     |
| NAT_ID_OTHER_P2              | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has a national identity from outside of the UK and Ireland, and if this is in conjunction with another UK/Irish national identity. |                     |
| ETHNIC_GROUP_INTERMEDIATE_P2 | Census 2021 - Indicates the intermediate level of aggregation for the ethnic group variable.                                                                                     |                     |
| ETHNIC_GROUP_AGG5_P2         | Census 2021 - Ethnic Group - aggregated (5 category)                                                                                                                             |                     |
| ETHNIC_GROUP_AGG2_P2         | Census 2021 - Ethnic Group - aggregated (2 category)                                                                                                                             |                     |

|                                            |                                                                                                                                                     |  |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| RELIGION_BELONG_TO_OR_BROUGHT_UP_IN_DVO_P2 | Census 2021 - Religion belongs to or was brought up in (4 category)                                                                                 |  |
| RELIGION_BELONG_TO_DVO_P2                  | Census 2021 - Religion belongs to (8 category)                                                                                                      |  |
| RELIGION_BROUGHT_UP_IN_DVO_P2              | Census 2021 – Religion brought up in (7 category)                                                                                                   |  |
| MAIN_LANGUAGE_AGG10_P2                     | Census 2021 - Main language - aggregated (10 category)                                                                                              |  |
| MAIN_LANGUAGE_AGG2_P2                      | Census 2021 - Main language - aggregated (2 category)                                                                                               |  |
| IRISH_SKILLS_IND_P2                        | Census 2021 - Indicates a person's ability to use the Irish language. (2 Category)                                                                  |  |
| ULSTER_SCOTS_SKILLS_IND_P2                 | Census 2021 - Indicates a person's ability to use the Ulster-Scots language. (2 Category)                                                           |  |
| DISABILITY_P2                              | Census 2021 - Long-term health problem or disability                                                                                                |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_IND_P2                    | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has one or more types of long-term health conditions.                                                 |  |
| HEALTH_IN_GENERAL_P2                       | Census 2021 - General health (5 category)                                                                                                           |  |
| IS_CARER_P2                                | Census 2021 - Provision of unpaid care                                                                                                              |  |
| HIGHEST_QUALIFICATION_P2                   | Census 2021 - Highest level of qualification                                                                                                        |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_MENTAL_HEALTH_P2          | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has an emotional, psychological or mental health condition (for example depression or schizophrenia). |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_AUTISM_P2                 | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has Autism or Asperger syndrome.                                                                      |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_LEARNING_DIFFICULTY_P2    | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has a learning difficulty (for example dyslexia).                                                     |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_BLIND_P2                  | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has blindness or partial sight loss                                                                   |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_BREATHING_P2              | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has shortness of breath or difficulty breathing (for example asthma)                                  |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_DEAF_P2                   | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has deafness or partial hearing loss                                                                  |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_CONFUSION_MEMORY_P2       | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has frequent periods of                                                                               |  |

|                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|                                                      | confusion or memory loss (for example dementia)                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_INTELLECTUAL_LEARNING_DISABILITY_P2 | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has a learning difficulty (for example dyslexia)                                                                                                                                |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_LONG_TERM_PAIN_P2                   | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has long-term pain or discomfort                                                                                                                                                |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_MOBILITY_PHYSICAL_P2                | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has an intellectual or learning disability (for example Down syndrome)                                                                                                          |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_MOBILITY_WHEELCHAIR_P2              | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has a mobility or dexterity difficulty that requires the use of a wheelchair                                                                                                    |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_OTHER_P2                            | Census 2021 - Indicates whether an individual has no long-term health conditions.                                                                                                                                             |  |
| HEALTH_CONDITION_NUMTC5                              | The number of long-term health conditions reported by a person. A long-term health condition is one which has lasted, or is expected to last, at least 12 months. In census, this is a self-assessment question. (6 category) |  |
| SEXUAL_ORIENTATION_DVO_AGG_3_P2                      | Census 2021 - Sexual orientation - aggregated (3 category)                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
| RACIAL_EQUALITY_TEO_P2                               | Census 2021 - Ethnic group of person using NI Executive Office equality definition                                                                                                                                            |  |
| ENGLISH_PROFICIENCY_P2                               | Census 2021 - Indicates if individuals have English as a main language, as well as the proficiency of that individual in English.                                                                                             |  |
| YEAR_ARRIVAL_NI_P2                                   | Census 2021 - Year of arrival in NI (aggregated)                                                                                                                                                                              |  |

## Household

| Variable Name                  | Variable Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Further Information |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| ENCRYPTED_HHID                 | Encrypted Household ID for linking                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                     |
| HH_SIZE_TC6_H2                 | Census 2021 - Number of usual residents in a household size (top coded to 6)                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| HH_SIZE_TC5_H2                 | Census 2021 - Number of usual residents in a household size (top coded to 5)                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| HH_SIZE_TC4_H2                 | Census 2021 - Number of usual residents in a household size (top coded to 4)                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| HH_SIZE_TC3_H2                 | Census 2021 - Number of usual residents in a household size (top coded to 3)                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| HH_SIZE_TC2_H2                 | Census 2021 - Number of usual residents in a household size (top coded to 2)                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| HH_ADULTS_AND_CHILDREN_H2      | Census 2021 - Identifies the makeup of the household in consideration of children (here defined as all persons under 16), adults, and adults aged 66 and above, split into one-person and multi-person households                           |                     |
| HH_ADULTS_AND_CHILDREN_AGG6_H2 | Census 2021 - Identifies the makeup of the household in consideration of children (here defined as all persons under 16), adults, and adults aged 66 and above, split into one-person and multi-person households - aggregated (6 category) |                     |
| HH_ADULTS_AND_CHILDREN_AGG2_H2 | Census 2021 - Number of adults in the household - aggregated (2 category)                                                                                                                                                                   |                     |
| HH_ADAPTED_IND_H2              | Census 2021 - Indicates whether a household has been designed or adapted.                                                                                                                                                                   |                     |
| HH_TENURE_H2                   | Census 2021 - Household tenure                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                     |
| HH_TENURE_AGG6_H2              | Census 2021 - Household tenure - aggregated (6 category)                                                                                                                                                                                    |                     |
| HH_TENURE_AGG3_H2              | Census 2021 - Household tenure - aggregated (3 category)                                                                                                                                                                                    |                     |
| HH_CAR_VAN_TC5_H2              | Census 2021 - Indicates the number of cars or vans that are owned, or available for use, by one or more members of a household (top coded to 5).                                                                                            |                     |
| HH_DEPENDENT_CHILDREN_H2       | Census 2021 - Number of dependent children in the household by the age of the youngest dependent child.                                                                                                                                     |                     |

|                                 |                                                                                                     |  |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| HH_CARERS_TC4_H2                | Census 2021 - Count of the number of unpaid carers in household (top coded to 4)                    |  |
| HH_CARERS_TC2_H2                | Census 2021 - Count of the number of unpaid carers in household (top coded to 2)                    |  |
| HH_DEPRIVATION_EDUCATION_H2     | Census 2021 - Shows if household has at least 1 resident that is deprived in relation to education  |  |
| HH_DEPRIVATION_HEALTH_H2        | Census 2021 - Shows if household has at least 1 resident that is deprived in relation to health     |  |
| HH_DEPRIVATION_HOUSING_H2       | Census 2021 - Shows if household is deprived in the housing dimension                               |  |
| HH_DEPRIVATION_EMPLOYMENT_H2    | Census 2021 - Shows if household has at least 1 resident that is deprived in relation to employment |  |
| HH_DEPRIVATION_H2               | Census 2021 - Shows if household is deprived in none or 1-4 areas                                   |  |
| HH_ADULTS_EMPLOYMENT_TC3_H2     | Census 2021 - Count of the number of adults in household that are in employment (top coded to 3)    |  |
| HH_FAMILY_COMPOSITION_AGG23_H2  | Census 2021 - Household composition - aggregated (23 category)                                      |  |
| HH_FAMILY_COMPOSITION_AGG14_H2  | Census 2021 - Household composition - aggregated (14 category)                                      |  |
| HH_FAMILY_COMPOSITION_AGG9_H2   | Census 2021 - Household composition - aggregated (9 category)                                       |  |
| HH_FAMILY_COMPOSITION_AGG5_H2   | Census 2021 - Household composition - aggregated (5 category)                                       |  |
| HH_FAMILY_COMPOSITION_AGG3_H2   | Census 2021 - Household composition - aggregated (3 category)                                       |  |
| HH_CENTRAL_HEATING_AGG10_H2     | Census 2021 - Central Heating type - aggregated (10 category)                                       |  |
| HH_CENTRAL_HEATING_RENEWABLE_H2 | Census 2021 - Indicates whether household has renewable heating system.                             |  |

## LPS

| Variable Name | Variable Description      | Further Information |
|---------------|---------------------------|---------------------|
| CV_NON_EX5    | Capital value in quintile |                     |

## Annex C: Useful links

Please note that this User Guide and the ASHE-Census 2021 Metadata and Data Dictionary will be made available within the secure setting for researchers accessing the ASHE-Census 2021 data. Please contact [rsu@nisra.gov.uk](mailto:rsu@nisra.gov.uk) for further details.

### Code of Practice for Statistics



Code\_of\_Practice\_for  
\_Statistics\_ed3\_Nov25

### The Statistics of Trade and Employment (NI) Order 1988



The Statistics of  
Trade and Employment

### Inter Departmental Business Register (IDBR)



Inter Departmental  
Business Register.pdf

### Further information about IDBR sources, structure and updating for publication



Further Information  
About IDBR Sources.p

### UK SIC 2007



UK SIC 2007.pdf

### A Guide to Business Legal Status



A Guide to Business  
Legal Status.pdf

### Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings (ASHE)

#### ASHE Background Quality Report



NI-ASHE-background  
-quality-report-2025\_

## [ASHE Questionnaire Guidance](#)



NI-ASHE-questionnaire-guidance-2025.pdf

## [ASHE Sample Form](#)



ASHE-2025-Sample-Form.pdf

## [ASHE Revisions Policy](#)



NI-ASHE-revisions-policy-2025.pdf

## [ASHE Usage](#)



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## [ASHE Summary Process Diagram](#)



ASHE-Summary-Process-Diagram.pdf

## [ASHE methodology](#)



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## [ASHE dataset notes](#)



ASHE Dataset Notes\_ 2022.pdf

## [NI Census 2021](#)

### [Sample Census 2021 Questionnaires](#)



2021-census-household-questionnaire.pdf



2021-census-individual-questionnaire.pdf

### [Census 2021 Statement About Data Quality](#)



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nt-about-data-quality

### [2021 Census Quality Survey Information Paper](#)



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quality-survey-inform

### [Census 2021 Data Processing Overview](#)



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ocessing-overview.pd

### [Census 2021 Methodology Overview](#)



Census 2021  
Methodology overvie

### [Census 2021 edit and imputation processing report](#)



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d-imputation-process

### [Census 2021 guidance note on use of religion question outputs](#)



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e-note-on-use-of-reliq

### [Census 2021 coverage information paper](#)



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e-information-paper.p

### [Census 2021 Quality Assurance Report](#)

### [Census 2021 Outputs Definitions](#)